

YC Work at a Startup — Application Answers (Joseph Goydish II)

Two versions: **General** (any startup/domain) and **Security** (cyber/appsec companies like RASPIRE).

Q1: Describe yourself in a short phrase

General (recommended)

B2B SaaS sales rep with D1 athlete discipline who built an AI-powered pipeline to land his next role.

General alternates

- "Sales operator who treats outbound like a season — relentless, coachable, numbers-driven"
- "3.5-year SaaS SDR with the work ethic of a college athlete and the curiosity of a self-taught engineer"
- "Revenue builder who applies research-grade rigor to every pipeline he touches"

Security version (for cyber companies)

Security researcher with 5 published Apple CVEs who sells to the security leaders he researches.

Q2: What are you looking for? What would you like to avoid?

General (recommended)

Looking for: An early-stage or founding GTM role where I can own top-of-funnel and help build the playbook from zero. I've spent 3.5 years in B2B SaaS sales (Cyberbit, FortifyData) and I want to apply that to a product I genuinely believe in and can explain cold. I'm looking to develop full-cycle selling — moving from SDR/BDR into closing — and I want to work on a small, remote-first team where my work directly moves revenue. I care about products with real traction and a clear ICP, and teams that value feedback and ownership over process theater.

Would like to avoid: SDR pods where you're a number in a dial-count machine with no strategy. Products I can't explain simply or don't believe in. Heavy bureaucracy and micromanaged activity tracking without ownership of outcomes. I'd rather be somewhere my voice shapes the motion.

Security version (for cyber companies)

Looking for: A founding or early GTM role at a security company where I can own top-of-funnel and build the playbook from zero. I've spent 3.5 years in B2B cybersecurity sales (Cyberbit, FortifyData) and I want to apply that to a product I can genuinely demo and defend technically. I'm drawn to deep-tech products (application security, threat intel, AI security) where my research background gives me credibility with buyers. I want to develop full-cycle selling and work on a small, remote-first team where my work directly moves revenue.

Would like to avoid: SDR pods where you're a number in a dial-count machine. Products I can't explain technically or don't believe

in. Heavy process over actual outreach. Micromanaged activity tracking without ownership of outcomes. I've seen both sides of how security teams buy — I'd rather be somewhere my voice shapes the motion.

Q3: Project you're proud of (start to finish)

General version — the AI job-hunt pipeline (recommended for non-security roles)

Building an AI-powered job-hunt command center — from idea to 40 qualified leads per run.

Motivation: I was tired of the standard job search — scrolling the same boards, applying late, competing with hundreds of applicants. I wanted to find opportunities before they got flooded, the way a good sales rep finds pipeline before the market does.

What I did: I built a full pipeline, solo. First, a crawler that hits Oxylabs' scraping API with targeted search dorks to pull direct ATS postings (Greenhouse, Ashby), LinkedIn hiring posts, and VC-backed startup boards. Then an AI enrichment layer that scores each lead against my resume, extracts the company, and writes a tailored outreach note. Finally, a dashboard that turns it all into an actionable command center — match scores, hiring-manager LinkedIn searches, and ready-to-send messages for every lead.

The challenge: Making it actionable, not just a list. I had to solve dedup across sources, manage API credit budgets so I wasn't burning money on duplicates, and force the AI output into a format I could act on — clean company names, real application URLs, notes under 150 characters. The hardest part was the last mile: turning raw scraped data into something that actually gets replies.

How I measured success: Each run produces ~40 fresh, deduplicated, AI-scored leads — with a direct application link and a

personalized outreach message for each one. I went from applying late to being first in line on early-signal postings, with a repeatable system I can run in minutes.

Why it matters for sales: It's literally the sales motion — prospecting, qualification, personalization, follow-through — applied to my own pipeline. It shows I build systems, manage resources, and execute, not just talk about activity.

Security version — the zero-click iOS attack chain (for cyber companies)

Reverse-engineering a zero-click iOS attack chain — from compromised device to 5 published CVEs.

Motivation: A device I was analyzing showed signs of compromise while in airplane mode — network traffic was still leaking through a shadow tunnel (utun2). Most people would have wiped it. I wanted to know how it got in, so I started pulling kernel telemetry and memory artifacts instead.

What I did: I traced the infection back through the stack: a malicious AMR audio file triggering heap memory corruption in CoreAudio, then a pointer-authentication bypass in the AppleBCM WLAN driver that turned it into a kernel read/write chain — fully zero-click. I then mapped a second chain: a single malicious PNG walking through ImageIO (out-of-bounds write), WebKit (heap corruption), and Core Media (use-after-free) to full kernel compromise. I extracted IOCs, wrote YARA signatures, and documented the whole chain with Shannon-Hartley verification of the covert channel.

The challenge: No access to Apple internals, no jailbreak, no vendor support — just device telemetry, logs, and patience. The hardest part was proving the chain end-to-end from artifacts alone, then coordinating responsible disclosure: reporting privately to Apple and

US-CERT, escalating through Google, and getting fixes shipped in iOS 18.4.1.

How I measured success: Five CVEs confirmed in the NVD (CVE-2025-31200, CVE-2025-31201, CVE-2025-43300, CVE-2025-24201, CVE-2025-24085), listed in CISA's Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog, and re-scored to CVSS 10.0 via CISA Vulnrichment. The research is published openly on my GitHub.

Why it matters for sales: This is exactly the work my buyers are trying to defend against. When I'm on a call with a security leader, I don't read from a script — I've lived the threat they're worried about.